Board Meeting

September 10, 2024

National Anthem

Loralie Ahola - Chinook Elementary Choir

National Anthem
Just One Candle

Superintendent Report

Superintendent Report

- Start of the school year
- VEA contract for board consideration
- Cell phone policy
  - Outreach to students, families, staff
  - Review of input through Advisories
  - Review what’s working and what’s not to inform next steps
- Safety
- Budget/Staffing
- Hate & Bias Protocol
- Strategic Plan Update

Budget Development: Next Steps

- Continue to balance staffing to meet student need
- Establish new baseline of services and needs with 260+ fewer positions
- Begin 25-26 budget development process
  - Establish staff costs for 24-25+
  - Enrollment (+ approx. 1% over forecasted - still verifying over the next several weeks)
  - Legislative session - advocacy
  - Other ongoing costs (inflation)
  - Levy expiration and possible renewal
- Class sizes and staffing
  - Change in practice - students served by an IEP rostered into general education classes as well as special education classes.
  - Distributing/adjusting additional staffing based on enrollment

Levy Renewal: Feb 2025 Consideration

- Capital Levy focused on technology will expire, 12.31.25
- Sept/Oct need analysis - Safety and Tech needs
- November Resolution consideration - Board desires to balance overall school tax rate with student need
- 2.11.25 Election day

Hate & Bias Protocol

Janell Ephraim, Andre Hargunani, Cezanne Tyner

Why?

- Student empathy interviews showed a need for a consistent response to hate and bias language
- Staff and community reported a need for training on how to interrupt incidents of hate and bias language
- Needed to strengthen safety and restorative process for repairing harm in our school community
- At schools that piloted the Hate & Bias Protocol, students and staff reported a decrease in incidents and that the school culture feels better

District-wide Restorative Response Plan

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS VPS

IF A STUDENT SAYS A SLUR AND/OR ENGAGES IN AN INCIDENT OF HATE/BIAS, THE FOLLOWING WILL HAPPEN:

- **Step 1:** A staff member will **interrupt** the harmful language ("Stop, that is hurtful.")
- **Step 2:** The staff member will write an **OFFICE referral** in Synergy for that student's behavior
- **Step 3: Guardian(s) will be contacted** (student harmed and student responsible)
- **Step 4:** The student responsible will participate in an **educational learning opportunity** on the type of harm they have caused.
- **Step 5:**
  - The student may be given the **opportunity for a restorative conversation/restorative re-entry** plan (depending on whether both students are willing to restore the harm)
  - The student responsible **may have additional disciplinary** consequences

IF the behavior happens again:

- A **formal meeting** with the student, family, and staff will be scheduled and building leadership will **explore exclusionary discipline** options as well as additional behavior interventions.

Speaking up against Hate & Bias

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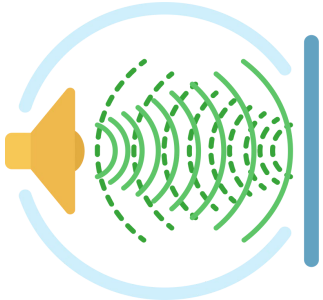
VPS

Interrupt

Question

Educate

Echo



Educational Component

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS VPS

PREVENTATIVE LESSONS

- Secondary Example Lesson Series
- Elementary Example1
- Elementary Example 2
- Elementary Example 3

For students who have received the Restorative Response Lessons, 94% had no further reported incidents of that language.

Tier 2: Restorative Response Lessons

Harm Caused	Pre-Learning Reflection Questions	High School Text	8th Grade Text	5th Grade Text	Picture Books	Videos
Stereotypes	What is a stereotype? How can stereotypes be harmful? What are some examples of stereotypes that exist?	Stereotypes (revised 6/18/24)	Stereotypes	Stereotypes	"A Kids Book About Racism"	Middle School Student Voice Part 2 Greater Good Berkeley Article
Comparison of Black People to Monkeys	Do you know where this comparison comes from? How does it cause harm?	Dehumanization (revised 6/18/24)	Dehumanization ADL response guide	Animalization		Video resource bank
N-word	What do you know about this word? Where do you think it comes from? How can it cause harm?	History of the N-word (revised 6/18/24)	N-word ADL response guide	N-word "A Kids Book About Racism"		Student Voice CR Student Voice
Antisemitic comments and jokes	What do you think antisemitism means? Who can be affected by this language?	Anti-Semitism (revised 6/10/24)	Anti Semitism	Anti Semitism		Facing History
Swastikas	What do you know about this symbol? How can it hurt other people? What does this symbol represent when it is drawn/shown?	History of the Swastika (revised 6/10/24)	History of the swastika	History of the Swastika		Facing History
Comparison of Latinos to farmers	Do you know what a stereotype is? How can this stereotype cause harm?	Racism in Agriculture (revised 6/10/24)	Racism in Agriculture	Racism in Agriculture		Video Article and videos

Feedback from Staff

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"The Hate & Bias presentation last week was well received by our staff. Many made comments about the authenticity in conversation being refreshing as well as the tools provided to support the protocol. Looking forward to the continued work!"

The consistency is leading to kids changing the behavior long term.

You can feel the change in culture.

Interrupting hate speech was a wonderful presentation. Very engaging and it was nice to all be in the same room generating great ideas about this really important effort.

Teachers are volunteering to teach the HBP themselves and work with their own students.

One of the best presentations I've heard in our trainings.

I'm so glad there is clear direction and that we can move this work along as a team.

I have already noticed a decrease in hate and bias speech than last year.

Strategic Planning Update

OUR MISSION

Inspiring Learning.

Growing Community.

Each student, Every day.

Vision of a
Graduate
EQUITY
EQUITY
EQUITY
EQUITY
Student-Centered
Staff
Foster equitable student achievement through a diverse, skilled Staff that promotes inclusion and safety while focusing on quality instruction.
Student-Centered
Community
Bring the community together in support of our students.
Student-Centered
Experience
Create a culture of belonging and positive relationships while preparing students for the demands of their next steps through engaging curriculum, instruction, and student experiences.

Student-Centered Experience

Student-Centered Experience

Develop/sustain a culture of belonging, safety and positive student-staff relationships

Promoting Positive First Experiences for VPS Students

Lake Shore incoming kindergarteners learn about school procedures during Jump Start

Incoming Kindergarteners "Jump Start" into 2024-25 School Year

Many of our youngest learners got to experience school before the official first day. On August 14 and 15, over 1,000 VPS students participated in Jump Start Kindergarten at their home elementary schools. Jump Start is a shortened-day experience that allows our incoming kindergartners an opportunity to become familiar with their teacher, classroom, learning routines, and settings within the school, to promote a positive transition.

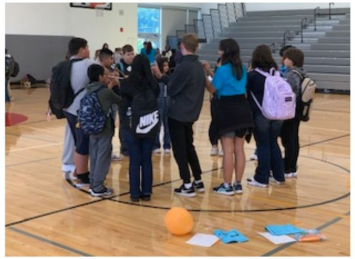
Data shows that students who attend Jump Start are better prepared for kindergarten than children who don't participate. During Jump Start, students make new friends and explore reading and math. These opportunities contribute to confidence, leadership skills, and enthusiasm for school.

What a strong start for our kindergarteners!

Sixth Grade Students Kick Start the 2024-25 School Year

Sixth grade is an important year for students transitioning into middle school. To support a positive start to the school year, all VPS middle schools hosted a 6th grade Kick Start for the first day of school. Kick Start provided the opportunity for 6th graders to attend school before 7th and 8th graders arrived. Students were able to meet teachers, follow their schedule and make new friends.

Over 1,350 students participated in the 6th Grade Kick Start. Students were so confident by the end of the Kick Start day. They were still nervous about all of the 7th and 8th graders coming the next day but they knew where to find all their classes and understand the structure of the school day. The first day of school was very smooth because the 6th graders had a stronger understanding of the routines, knowing what to expect, and some initial relationships in the school community.



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Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E1): Attendance

Develop/sustain a culture of belonging, safety, and positive student-staff relationships

Baseline Data 2023-24 School Year

62.7%

At or above 90% attendance

Disparity between the lowest student group and the highest student group is currently at: Highest 72.9%, Lowest 38.3% with a Difference of 34.6%

Proposed Goal

In the 2024-25 school year, 65.03% of VPS students will attend school regularly for at least 90% of all school days.

In the 2024-2025 school year, reduce the disparity in attendance rates between student groups by 10%

Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E1): Discipline

Develop/sustain a culture of belonging, safety, and positive student-staff relationships

Baseline Data 2023-24 School Year

<u>2022-23 School Year</u>
Disparity between lowest student group and highest student group:
58 Days per 100 Students

<u>2023-24 School Year</u>
Disparity between lowest student group and highest student group:
40.47 Days per 100 Students

Proposed Goals

Reduce the disparity in exclusionary discipline rates between student groups by 10%

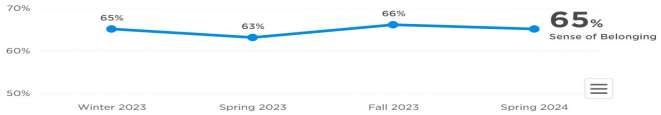
Increase the use of Restorative Justice Practices in student discipline by 20%

Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E1): Belonging

Develop/sustain a culture of belonging, safety, and positive student-staff relationships

Baseline Data 2023-24 School Year

3rd-5th Grade

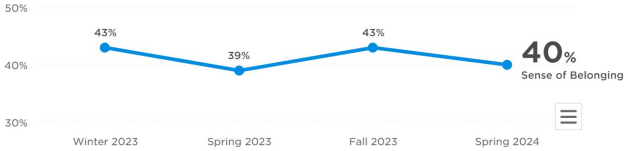


QUESTION

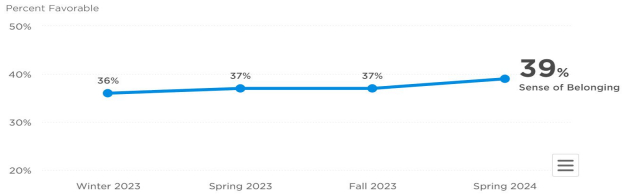
How much respect do students at your school show you?

55% responded favorably

Middle School



High School



QUESTION

How connected do you feel to the adults at your school?

35% responded favorably

Proposed Goal

<u>Elementary</u>
70% of elementary students will demonstrate that they feel they are a valued member of their school community, as measured by Spring ‘25 Panorama Survey.
Focus Area: 60% of elementary students will respond favorably that students at their school show them respect, as measured by Spring ‘25 Panorama Survey.

<u>Middle School</u>
45% of middle school students will demonstrate that they feel they are a valued member of their school community, as measured by Spring ‘25 Panorama Survey.
Focus Area: 39% of middle school students will feel connected to the adults at their school, as measured by Spring ‘25 Panorama Survey.

<u>High School</u>
44% of high school students will demonstrate that they feel they are a valued member of their school community, as measured by Spring ‘25 Panorama Survey.
Focus Area: 40% of high school students will feel connected to adults at their school, as measured by Spring ‘25 Panorama Survey.

State Report Card

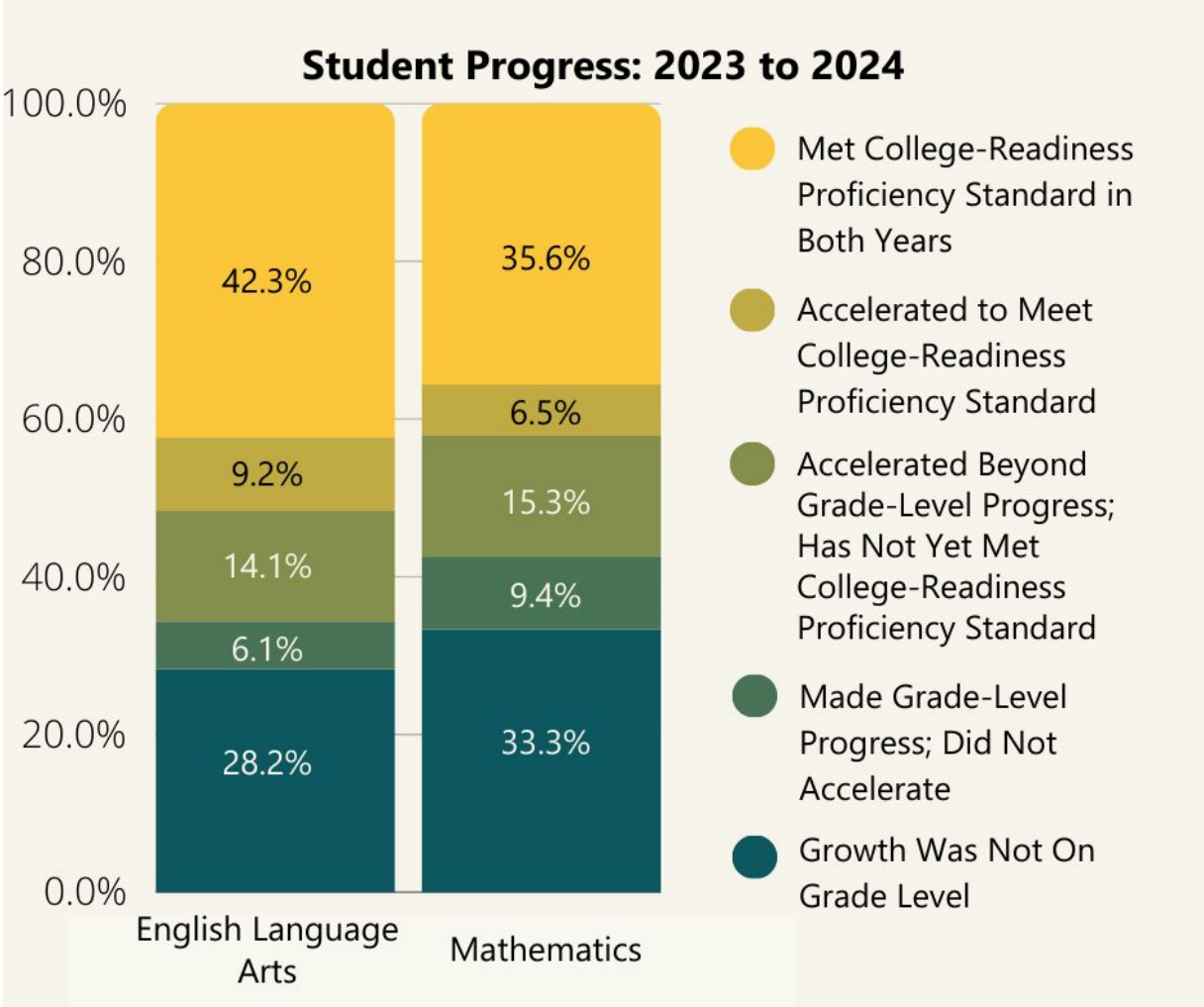
- Released today
- A different look at Smarter Balanced Assessment Data

Unpacking Smarter Balanced Assessment Scores: What do the scores mean?

[Letter to States (Smarter)]

[Overview]

[Questions & Answers]



Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E2): Literacy & Language

Prepare each student for the opportunities and demands of the next steps on their vision of a VPS graduate journey.

<u>Baseline Data</u> 2023-24 School Year

39.3% L3, L4

60.9% L2, L3, L4

SBA ELA
verifying data

Proposed Goals

By June 2029, 85% of students in grades 3-8 will demonstrate proficiency (L2, L3 or L4) on the SBA assessment for mathematics. In the coming year, 65% of students in grades 3-8 will demonstrate proficiency in literacy on SBA.

We will reduce the disparity in achievement rates between student groups by 10% each year.

We will focus and progress monitor via DIBELS benchmarking (K-2), iReady benchmarking (grades 3-8) HS Interim Assessments.

Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E2): Multilingual Learners

Prepare each student for the opportunities and demands of the next steps on their vision of a VPS graduate journey.

<u>Baseline Data</u> 2023-24 School Year

4.9%

WIDA ACCESS

Proposed Goals

1. **Increase WIDA Exit Rates:**
   - **Current Rate:** 4.9%
   - **Goal:** Increase WIDA exit rates for Multilingual learners to 10% by June 2025.
2. **Increase Graduation Rates:**
   - **Current Rate:** 68.4%
   - **Goal:** Increase the graduation rate of Multilingual learners to 75% by June 2025.
3. **Reduce the Number of Long-Term English Learners (LTELs):**
   - **Current Number:** 39% (1,552 students)
   - **Goal:** Reduce the percentage of Long-Term English Learners from 39% to 30% by June 2025.

Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E2): Mathematics

Prepare each student for the opportunities and demands of the next steps on their vision of a VPS graduate journey.

Baseline Data 2023-24 School Year

28.9% L3, L4

51.7% L2, L3, L4

SBA Mathematics
verifying data

Proposed Goal

By June 2029, 76.7% of VPS students will demonstrate proficiency (L2, L3 or L4) on the SBA assessment for mathematics. In the coming year, by June 2025 56.7% of students will be proficient on the SBA assessment.

In addition, we have a goal to reduce the disparity in achievement rates between student groups by 10% each year.

We will focus and progress monitor this goal through the Algebra & Algebraic Thinking strand in iReady and the high school Interim Assessment blocks Interpreting Functions, Solve Equations & Inequalities and Create Equations: Linear & Exponential.

Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E2): Early Childhood Learning

Prepare each student for the opportunities and demands of the next steps on their vision of a VPS graduate journey.

Baseline Data 2023-24 School Year

Domain	TK Students (Fall)	Inclusion/ECSE Students (Fall)
Social/Emotional	63%	27%
Physical	88%	62%
Language	75%	39%
Cognitive	62%	42%
Literacy	84%	35%
Mathematics	56%	27%

Resource

Proposed Goal

Increase access and inclusion for early learners in preparation for their K-12 experience, leading to improved academic performance and social-emotional development throughout their educational journey

By June 2025, 65% of Kindergarteners who participated in VPS early learning programs prior to Kindergarten, will meet proficiency in 5 or more areas of the WA Kids assessment

Strategic Plan Student-Centered Experience Goal #1 (E2): Graduation/CTE Pathways

Prepare each student for the opportunities and demands of the next steps on their vision of a VPS graduate journey.

Baseline Data 2023-24 School Year

55.8%

Math/ELA Graduation Pathway

Proposed Goal

Increase the percentage of students meeting the Math (from 55% to 60%) and/or ELA Graduation Pathway requirement by increasing access to dual credit coursework.

School Board Level Goals

- Attendance
- Discipline
- Belonging
- Literacy & Language
- Multilingual Learners
- Mathematics
- Early Childhood
- Graduation Pathways

Recognition

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Washington School Recognition Program 2021-22

Benjamin Franklin Elementary: Closing Gaps for one or more student groups

Chinook Elementary School: Growth for one or more student groups

George C Marshall Elementary: Growth for one or more student groups

Hudson's Bay High School: Closing Gaps for English Learner Progress

Lewis and Clark High School (Vancouver Flex Academy): Closing Gaps for Graduation

Lincoln Elementary School: Closing Gaps for the whole school

Salmon Creek Elementary: Closing Gaps and Growth for one or more student groups

Vancouver School of Arts and Academics: Achievement for the whole school

Walnut Grove Elementary: Growth for one or more student groups

Washington School Recognition Program 2022-23

Lincoln Elementary School: Growth for one or more student groups

Sacajawea Elementary School: Growth for one or more student groups

AWSP/AWSL Washington Schools on the Rise Award

Skyview High School

VPS Coaches of the Year

High School

Breanne Smedley

Mark Ganter

Middle School

Ariel Goldsworth

Patrick Storment

WA State Athletic Individual Achievements

Columbia River High School Track and Field

1st Place

Revac Banfield - 100-meter dash and 200-meter dash

2nd Place

Jacob McManus - 1,600 meter run and 3,200 meter run

3rd Place

4x100 relay team Seth Arnett, Solomon Menendez, John Reeder, Revac Banfield

WA State Athletic Team Championship - Spring 2024

1st Place

Columbia River High School Boys Track and Field

WA State Athletic Team Championship - Spring 2024

1st Place

Columbia River High School Baseball

WA State Athletic Team Championship - Spring 2024

1st Place

Columbia River High School Girls Tennis

WA State Athletic Team Championship - Spring 2024

3rd Place

Skyview High School Girls Softball